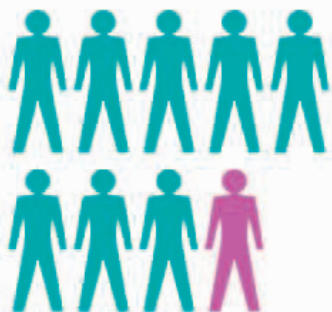




The ruins of the old Kandahar citadel, Afghanistan, lie on the hilltop behind the 12th-century arch. In the Persian siege, Hussein Hotaki took refuge in the citadel but surrendered after it was bombarded by Nader Shah.

THE AFGHAN HOTAKI DYNASTY had been expelled from Persia in 1729 by Nader Shah (1698–1747), and he was also determined to eliminate the remaining threat posed by the Afghan **Ghilzai** people. Having occupied southern Afghanistan in 1737, he besieged the Hotaki stronghold of **Kandahar** in 1738. Nader Shah exiled Hussein, last of the Hotakis, destroyed the towns of Kandahar and Qalat-i-Ghilzai, and finally **crushed the hopes of the Ghilzais** by backing the rise of the rival Afghan **Durrani** people. Afghanistan was then part of the Mughal Empire, centered in Delhi, but the Mughal governor had been powerless to stop Nader Shah's **Persian force**, which swept through Kabul and **crossed the Indus** in December 1738. After defeating the forces of Mughal Muhammad Shah in the **Battle of Karnal** in February



8:1 **Battle of Karnal**
Trying to prevent Nader Shah's Persian invading army from reaching Delhi, the Mughals lost 20,000 men while the Persians lost only 2,500.

1739, around 68 miles (110 km) from Delhi, Nader Shah entered the city victorious on March 9, 1739. The Mughal treasury was empty but the shah **seized the emperor's personal jewels**, including the famous Koh-i-Noor and Darya-e-Noor diamonds.

Also in 1739, the **Austro-Turkish War** (1737–39) was ended by the Treaty of Belgrade. In the same year, the Treaty of Niš brought the **Russo-Turkish War** (1735–39) to a conclusion. Both these treaties confirmed Austria's loss of northern Serbia and Belgrade to the Ottomans, obliging Russia to abandon hopes of capturing the Crimea, although the Russians were allowed to build an unfortified port at Azov and trade on the Black Sea.

Hostilities broke out once again between **Britain and Spain** in 1739. Britain had been awarded limited rights to trade slaves and goods in the Spanish colonies (see 1713), but increasingly, the Spanish were seizing British cargoes. In 1731, Spanish coastguards had severed the ear of a British captain, Robert Jenkins, and in 1739 the case led to a war, which was later dubbed the **War of Jenkins' Ear** by the Scottish historian Thomas Carlyle. Britain began to attack Spanish possessions in the New World, such as the Spanish naval base of Porto Bello in Panama. Following the **Battle of Porto Bello**, the British took possession of the settlement in November 1739. The Viceroyalty of New Spain, first established in the early



16th century, responded by increasing its defenses around the Caribbean coast.

In **North America**, French colonists were maintaining their drive to **push westward** into Spanish territories. A priority was to identify a route to **link the**

Battle of Porto Bello
Fought in 1739, in the early stages of the War of Jenkins' Ear, the Battle of Porto Bello resulted in the British seizing the settlement from Spain.



Administration of empire

The Viceroyalty of New Spain, centered on the Caribbean and Gulf of Mexico was the first of four created to govern Spanish New World territories.

Mississippi Basin with Spanish **Colorado** and **Santa Fe**. In 1739, two French brothers, **Pierre and Paul Mallet**, opened up a **route** by negotiating the Missouri and Platte rivers, traveling southward to the Arkansas River, from where a local man guided them to Santa Fe. Despite the continuing existence of a buffer state of warring American Indian tribes, a link between the French and Spanish settlements was established.



Frederick II (left) converses with the Marquis d'Argens near Sanssouci.

WITH THE DEATH OF KING FREDERICK WILLIAM I OF PRUSSIA

in 1740, his son, Frederick II (1712–86), ascended to the throne. In his youth, Frederick II had been fond of music, poetry, and philosophy. He studied the works of Niccolò Machiavelli (see 1513) in preparation for kingship, and in 1739 wrote a refutation of the Renaissance Florentine's ideas, *Anti-Machiavel*, which he published anonymously in 1740. His rule was characterized by modernization, tolerance, and patronage of the arts. Yet he became known as **Frederick the Great** for the political and military feats by which he first expanded the borders of Prussia (until 1701 known as Brandenburg-Prussia) far beyond their historical limits, then defended these acquisitions against massive coalitions of powerful enemies. Frederick II's first opportunity to expand Prussia's frontiers arrived quickly after his accession. The Habsburg emperor, Charles VI, died in 1740 and was succeeded by his daughter, Maria Theresa (1717–80), who was to rule Austria's hereditary domains with her husband, Francis Stephen, as Holy Roman Emperor. Immediately, Prussia and France challenged the arrangement. Most of Europe took sides in what became the **War of the Austrian Succession** (1740–48), with Britain, the Dutch Republic, Sardinia, and Saxony supporting the queen. Frederick, claiming inheritance of **Silesia**—parts of present-day Poland, Germany,

March 25, 1738
Hussein Hotaki surrenders to Nader Shah at Kandahar, Afghanistan

June 1738
Nader Shah's Persian army occupies Kabul, Afghanistan

February 13, 1739
Nader Shah's Persian army wins Battle of Karnal against Mughal Muhammad Shah

March 9, 1739
Nader Shah's Persian army takes Delhi, the Mughal capital

May 1739
Nader Shah's Persian army leaves Delhi, laden with booty

June 1739
French explorers, the Mallet brothers, encounter route to Santa Fe

July 10, 1739
British King George II authorizes naval reprisals against Spain

July 22, 1739
Mallet brothers complete route from Mississippi to Santa Fe

September 18, 1739
Ottoman and Austrian empires sign Treaty of Belgrade

September 29, 1739
Ottoman and Russian empires sign Treaty of Niš

October 23, 1739
Britain declares war on Spain, later called War of Jenkins' Ear

November 22, 1739
British capture Spanish-held Porto Bello, Panama

May 31, 1740
Frederick II the Great becomes king of Prussia

September 1740
Frederick II's Anti-Machiavel published anonymously

October 20, 1740
Charles VI dies (b. 1685); Maria Theresa becomes ruler of the Habsburg Hereditary Lands

1740
Mon people gain independence from Toungoo Kingdom